

Ben Claflin

ben.c.claflin@gmail.com | 512-960-6205 | linkedin.com/in/ben-claflin/

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin

Bachelor of Science in Architectural Engineering, Minor in History

GPA: 3.85

May 2025

SKILLS

Software: Python, MATLAB, SQL, Figma, Asana, AWS SageMaker, & MS Excel, Project, Azure DevOps, & Power BI

Certifications: IBM AI Product Management, Scrum: Advanced, and *Interim Secret Clearance* (Mar. 2024)

Languages: German (Advanced Proficiency) and Dutch (Elementary Proficiency)

Relevant Coursework: Physics I & II, Differential Equations, Linear Algebra, Thermodynamics, and Computer Methods

RELEVANT WORK EXPERIENCE

NobleReach Foundation – AI Fellow (Washington, DC)

Aug. 2025 – Present

- Engaged with leaders across the private and public sector like former Secretary of Defense Bob Gates, Navy CTO Justin Fanelli, and retired General Paul Nakasone to learn about AI development within national security
- Partnered with mission-driven organization to design, develop, and implement next-generation AI solutions

SHI – AI ML Associate Product Owner (Austin, TX)

May 2024 – Aug. 2025

- Collaborated with the AI ML development team to investigate the pain points of a \$14 billion IT solutions provider's fraud detection system, interviewing 30+ senior stakeholders across nine organizations
- Developed SHI's first fraud detection dashboard, highlighting over 33,000 hours of inefficiencies and millions of underreported losses using Power BI- guiding solution prioritization across Sales, eCommerce, IT and Finance
- Designed and implemented AI Chatbot into global sales processes, streamlining fraud prevention for 1000+ sales representatives and delivering the first fraud prevention upgrade in 5 years

U.S. Department of State – European Intelligence Analyst (Remote)

Aug. 2023 – Jul. 2024

- Collaborated with Bureau of Intelligence and Research (INR) analysts to assess critical national security issues like the Israel-Hamas and Ukraine-Russia wars, artificial intelligence, and destabilizing factors in Europe using OSINT
- Published 10 classified analytical products that were distributed throughout the U.S. Executive Branch and shared with U.S. allies, providing policymakers with the insights and knowledge to advance American objectives

MentorRing – Product Manager (Austin, TX)

Aug. 2021 – May 2024

- Awarded \$20,000 from the U.S. Department of State to head the development of a website and app that connects international exchange students with alumni to provide guidance and support
- Integrated *MentorRing* into Fulbright Prism, UT for Me and private companies by customizing the user interface to meet the specific needs and goals of each program
- Provided each mentoring program with timely resources and targeted support by systemically analyzing data on participants' everyday challenges, from mental health to financial burdens

U.S. Department of State – Data Analyst (Washington, DC)

Jan. 2024 – Mar. 2024

- Utilized Power BI and Excel to develop an automated data analysis algorithm for the Bureau of Educational and Cultural Affairs (ECA), flagging security risks from 50,000 threats to inform U.S. strategy
- Discovered a nation's intentional abuse of U.S. cultural exchange programs to circumvent visa laws, resulting in a substantial reduction of visas awarded to the nation

The University of Texas at Austin – UT for Me Lead Ambassador (Austin, TX)

Aug. 2021 – Dec. 2023

- Supported 9,000 low-income UT Austin students by creating multiple community support programs, social media campaigns, and fundraising events with top UT Austin donors
- Spearheaded the implementation of UT for Me's first mentoring program by designing the curriculum for 75 mentees, managing 20 ambassadors, and enhancing each participant's professional skills

Harvey-Cleary Builders – Project Management Intern (Austin, TX)

Jun. 2023 – Aug. 2023

- Coordinated planning, tracking, and execution of all technical aspects of 8 interior projects worth over \$50 million
- Led team of 70+ subcontractors to ensure accurate and on-time completion of master schedule's key milestones
- Identified critical path issues and implemented solutions to complete the project 12% or \$240,000 under budget

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Clements Center for National Security – *Senior Undergraduate Fellow* (Austin, TX) Aug. 2022 – Jul. 2025

- Led discussions on U.S. foreign policy challenges, met with national security experts, studied the U.S.-U.K. relationship at King's College London, and investigated Korean reunification in South Korea and Japan
- Engaged with experts like Condoleezza Rice, Antony Blinken, Mike Pence, and Admiral McRaven to develop a critical understanding of U.S. security objectives and technology's role in achieving them

American Enterprise Institute (AEI) – *Scholar* (Washington, DC) Jun. 2025

- Investigated the theory of war, peace, and strategy while participating in Kori Schake's Thinking about War course
- Conducted briefing and policy exercises examining US strategy towards Iran, Russia, and China

West Point Student Conference on U.S. Affairs (SCUSA) – *Delegate* (West Point, NY) Oct. 2024

- Selected as one of six UT Austin scholars to participate in the 75th SCUSA at West Point, participating in roundtable discussions surrounding America's role in an increasingly multipolar world
- Created a policy memorandum that optimizes the U.S. military-industrial base to effectively compete in a multipolar world while establishing long-lasting civil-military relationships with future military and private sector leaders

Intelligence Studies Project's Texas Intelligence Academy – *Scholar* (Washington, DC) May 2024

- One of 15 students selected for the Texas Intelligence Academy: a 10-day course on the U.S. Intelligence Community (IC), including meetings with CIA Director John Brennan and INR Assistant Secretary Brett Holmgren
- Gained a critical understanding of the crucial and complex work of the IC via visits to CIA HQ, the U.S. Department of State's INR, and the Department of Homeland Security (DHS)

Global Disinformation Lab – *Cyber Researcher* (Austin, TX) Aug. 2023 – Dec. 2023

- Analyzed Chinese cyber security laws and tracked zero-day exploit, distributed denial of service (DDoS), advanced persistent threat (APT), brute force, and Internet of Things (IoT) cyber-attacks originating from China
- Systematically evaluated Chinese Communist Party (CCP) cyber policy and attacks to develop trends and policy recommendations that highlight cyber activity throughout the Indo-Pacific for the Army Cyber Institute

Normandy Scholar Program on WWII – *Scholar* (Austin, TX) Jan. 2022 – Jun. 2022

- Competitively selected to study WWII from France, Germany, the U.K., U.S., and U.S.S.R.'s perspectives for a semester and visit conflict sites across Europe
- Wrote a 30-page research paper on U.S. – China WWII relations, the foundation of today's great power competition

SERVICE

Texas Wranglers – *Member & Former Secretary* (Austin, TX) Aug. 2022 – Present

- Helped raise roughly \$40,000 for Central Texas Easterseals through Texas Wranglers' City Wide Hold Up
- Supported the Austin community with over 150 hours of service assisting handicapped students and veterans

Congress Bundestag Youth Exchange Alumni Association – *Mentor* (Austin, TX) Jun. 2020 – Aug. 2023

- Mentored high school students selected to spend a year in Germany as one of the 250 youth ambassadors representing the U.S. on a fully paid exchange
- Supported students as they prepared for their exchange, highlighting potential challenges, opportunities, and cultural differences they may experience abroad

AWARDS

U.S Department of State – *Gilman Scholarship Recipient* 2024 & 2025

U.S. Department of State – *Citizen Diplomacy Action Grant Recipient* 2021 & 2022

Distinguished Alumni Endowed Scholarship in Architectural Engineering – *Recipient* 2021 & 2022

The University of Texas at Austin – *University Honors* 2022, 2023 & 2024

Congress-Bundestag Youth Exchange – *American Ambassador* 2019